

ENTREPRENEURIAL PULSE



E-club APIIT

apiit_eclub



THE ART OF NEGOTIATION

**IN**

this current day and age where business operations have become more increasingly volatile and dynamic, the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT in partnership with MDMMS of APIIT Colom

-bo organized a workshop focusing on the Art of Negotiation, a project which would focus on the role negotiation plays in the current world and why it is an important competency to possess. Ms. Saranee Gunathilaka, an Attorney-At-Law, accredited Mediator (SIMI/IMI/IICA) and Master Negotiator from Harvard was the resource person for the Art of Negotiation. The workshop took place on the 26th of April 2024 at the School of Foundation, Access Towers II from 9.30AM to 11.30AM.



The session focused on the benefits of effective negotiation, common negotiation scenarios for entrepreneurs, setting negotiation goals and clear objectives, communication strategies and crafting clear and compelling arguments. It also highlighted the first ever interclub collaboration between the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT and Moot, Mock and Debating Society of APIIT Colombo, setting the foundation for the future collaborations between the two clubs with the project being chaired by President Vidussh Gunasekera and Head of Media Keshiny Sritharan.

Art of NEGOTIATION

The workshop was also paired with a special gift in the form of a giveaway with a lucky participant being provided the opportunity to bad a voucher from Butter Boutique. With an engaging audience and high number of participants, the Entrepreneurship Club of APIIT was able to conclude another project successfully, further highlighting the club's commitment to impart knowledge and useful skills on the student community of APIIT.



STUDENT ENTREPRENEUR SPOTLIGHT:

SHERAYA SAMARANAYAKE

1. What sparked your entrepreneurial spirit? How did you come up with your business idea?

It was entirely a passion I had for getting my nails done. I'd always get my nails done frequently because I love doing it; however, I noticed that getting acrylic or gel nails done truly damaged my nail bed, which made me switch to press-ons that were quick and easy to use and barely left a mark!

This sparked an idea in me: "Why not do what I love and make a business out of it?"

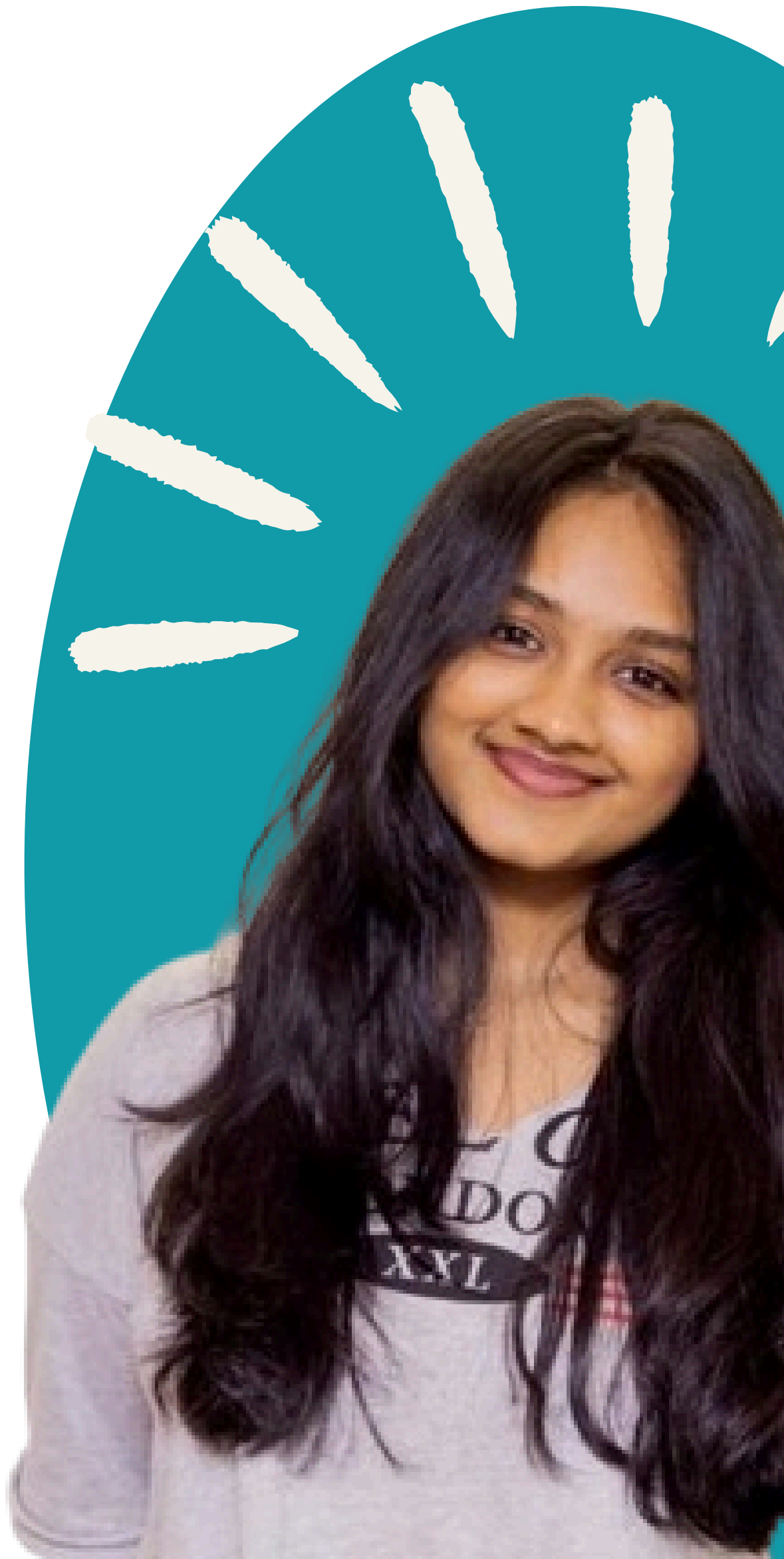
2. What have been the biggest challenges you've faced so far? What have you learned the most from these experiences?

Balancing tutoring, assignments, and meeting customer orders. At the inception of my business, it was quite easygoing; my brand was known to only a few people, and I didn't have to meet too many customer orders; however, within the next month, I was selling out quickly, which led to many deliveries needing to be met as well.

3. Why do you prefer running your own venture?

It's not entirely about the profit for me. It's about me enjoying what I do, and getting better at doing manicures on my customers!

But doing my own venture gives me the peace of mind to be creative and explore my vision freely.



4. How do you balance your studies with running your business? Do you have any time management tips for other student entrepreneurs?

It's all about how you prioritize your daily routines, in my case, education has been the bigger priority for me pretty much all my life.. but it doesn't essentially restrict me from having time to do anything else; I don't have to force myself to manage my business activity, because I simply enjoy it!

My piece of advice is to do something you enjoy doing; that way, you won't have to "make time" for it, but rather you will naturally prioritize and dedicate time to it!

5. What resources have been most helpful to you as a student entrepreneur?

Social media, particularly Instagram and Canva.

6. How are you marketing your business and reaching your target audience? What strategies have been most effective?

Social media, particularly Instagram, has been instrumental for me in understanding and interpreting its algorithm. This has enabled my content to reach the precise audience I aim to target. Additionally, Canva has been invaluable in creating visually appealing videos and poster ads, capturing the attention of both my current clients and potential customers.

7. What impact do you hope your business will have? Where do you see your business in 5-10 years?

I hope my business will empower individuals by enhancing their confidence and self-expression through quality nail services. I aim to set a standard of excellence in the beauty industry, inspiring others to pursue their passions fearlessly. Additionally, I aspire to create a positive and inclusive community where clients feel valued, respected, and beautiful.



@nailexpressbyscery

8. Do you have any mentors or advisors who have supported your journey? What advice would you give to other students seeking mentorship?

I'd say my parents. They always saw potential in me and encouraged me to take risks. Regardless of whether my business would succeed or fail, they believed that the learnings gained along the way were what truly mattered in creating a beautiful outcome.

9. What are your top three pieces of advice for aspiring student entrepreneurs?

Pursue your passion, embrace failure as a learning opportunity, and build a strong support system to fuel motivation and make the entrepreneurial journey enjoyable. Surround yourself with mentors, peers, and advisors who offer guidance, support, and constructive feedback.



10. What keeps you motivated and inspired?

My main source of motivation and inspiration comes from the positive impact I see on my clients. Their satisfaction and increased confidence remind me of why I started this business in the first place. Additionally, the continuous learning and growth opportunities in the beauty industry keep me inspired to innovate and improve.

11. Looking back, would you do anything differently? What have you enjoyed most about your entrepreneurial journey as a student?

I wouldn't change anything. Everything I've built for my brand today is a result of how I started at its inception.

The most enjoyable part of my entrepreneurial journey as a student has been the opportunity to combine my passion for beauty and creativity with business.

SMALL BUSINESS AND IT'S ECONOMIC IMPORTANCE

BY JANANI CHAYA WALISINGHA



Economic development is largely based on small enterprises. Especially in less urbanized areas, they are the largest employers. For the production generated by a single region, small businesses are responsible. Growing entrepreneurial skills foster innovation. Today, this is the basis for the socio-economic development of EU countries. The increase in the opening of small enterprises contributes positively to the economic development measured by the per capita value of total production generated by local entrepreneurs, as well as the number of employees. Small businesses contribute positively to the economic development of the country.

The GDP positively impacts the country's economic development. The rapid growth of small-scale businesses started in the 1970s and continues to this day. Small businesses are characterized by flexibility, agility, and the ability to quickly respond to market requirements. This contributes to the improving quality of goods and services, introducing innovation plays a significant role in creating new jobs which reduces unemployment.



The importance of small businesses is evidenced by their high presence in the economic structure of the country. Ultimately, small business performance is recovering from the COVID-19 pandemic faster than anticipated but has yet to reflect normal growth rates. The survival rate of small businesses is two-thirds. Small business is among the most powerful symbols of modern capitalism. The real boom in small business political consciousness came in the early 20th century. Small businesses, in other words, achieved their value through their innovative contributions rather than servicing or maintaining an existing system.



According to the latest SBA figures, small businesses employ nearly half of all private sector workers, which is represented by 46.4%. In addition, small businesses are often seen as nimbler than their larger counterparts, making them a major source of new innovations. In addition, studies have shown that small business owners are more satisfied with their jobs than others. Small businesses transform and develop communities. New small businesses are critical for economic growth and innovative capacity. The main interests of new small businesses are critical for economic growth and innovative capacity. Poverty reduction and economic growth are the main political interests in entrepreneurship.

The annual report of European Union small businesses confirmed that small businesses remain the European Union's economic backbone despite the global financial crisis. 66% of small businesses contribute to employment in the European Union. Attention to small businesses has been heightened because of the globalizing economy and the increasing severe competition that is inherent in the development.

SMEs are largely run by women. This facilitates the development of SME's, which allows society to capitalize on the skills of educated and trained women who may be blocked in corporate advancement because of the 'glass ceiling'. The increased flexibility inherent in owning one's own business allows women to contribute to the income of their families while balancing their work and family responsibilities, thus enhancing social cohesion.



Small businesses face regulatory challenges. These regulations include tax, licencing and permits. Failing to comply with these regulations can result in costly fines and legal fees, which can be detrimental to small businesses. By creating a favourable environment for small businesses, governments can help promote economic growth and job creation.

Entrepreneurship is the process that leads to the creation of SMEs while they fund their businesses by taking small business loans. Small businesses contribute significantly to GDP and employment rates. These enterprises encompass a wide range of industries, from local firms. Regardless of the sector, small businesses share a common trait: the entrepreneurial spirit that drives them to solve problems and meet the needs of their communities.

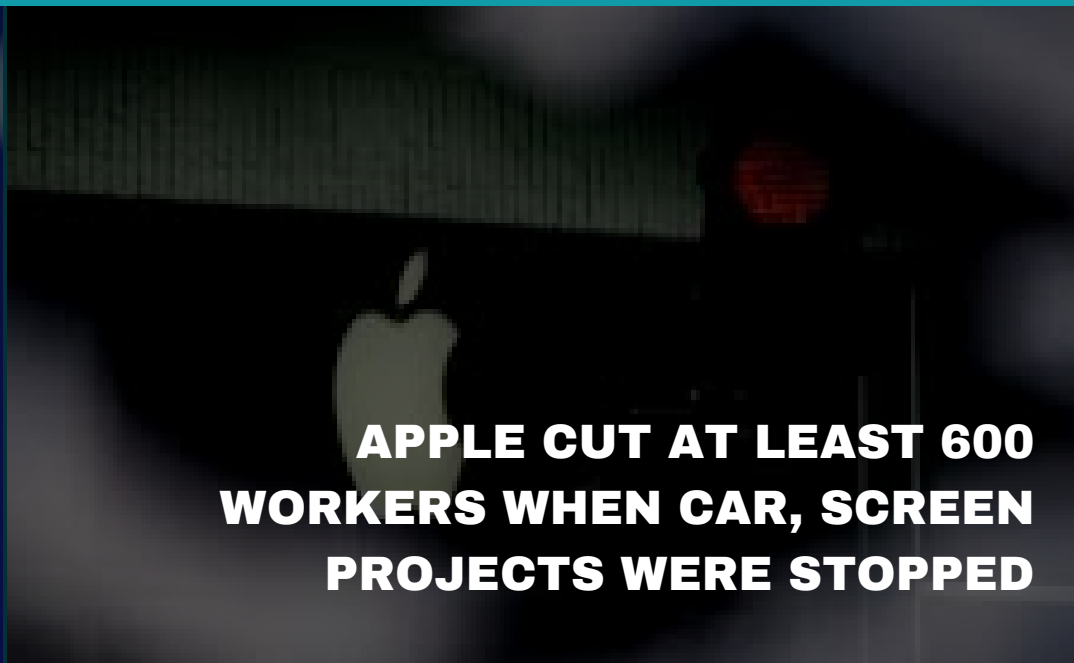
Finally, small businesses are playing a vital role in the overall development of the economy because they produce a lot of employment opportunities for the young generation. This concept plays a vital role in fulfilling the demands of business and the daily demands of individuals.

BUSINESS UPDATES

MARK ZUCKERBERG'S WEALTH EXCEEDS ELON MUSK'S FOR THE FIRST TIME SINCE 2020



APPLE CUT AT LEAST 600 WORKERS WHEN CAR, SCREEN PROJECTS WERE STOPPED



MCKINSEY AND GOOGLE CLOUD HELP COMPANIES TAP INTO \$4 TRILLION OF BUSINESS VALUE WITH GENERATIVE AI

Google Cloud

COMBANK BREAKS NEW GROUND IN SRI LANKA ENABLING AIRPLAY QR PAYMENTS FOR MERCHANTS



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WINNER
SULAIYA FAWAZ

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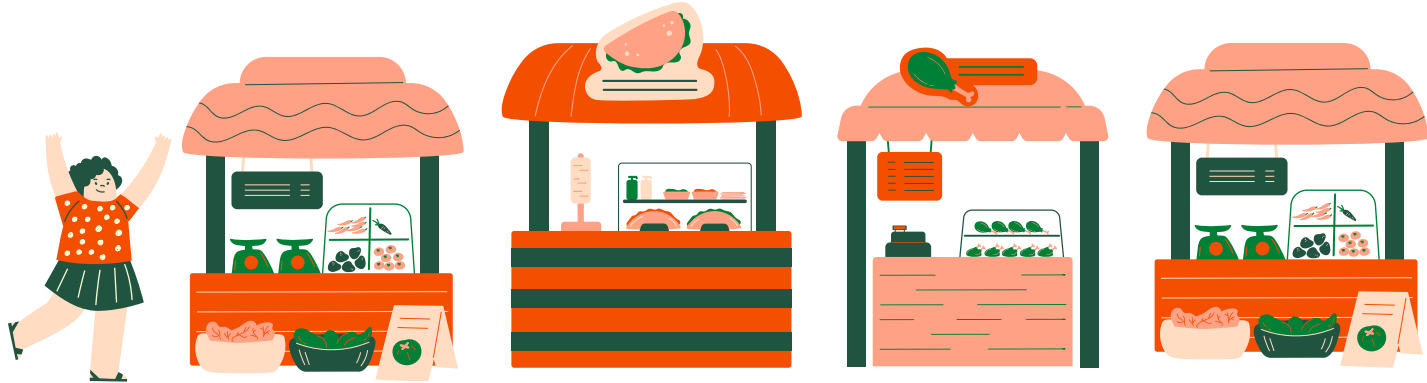


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